

Bakery Track – Interview

1. Can you briefly describe your project and your role within it?

I led the Bakery track, where we worked with a local bakery to understand how sustainability shows up in their daily operations. I coordinated the research, prepared the interview, conducted it, and helped the team turn what we learned into a final output.

2. What type of data did you collect during the project?

We did collect data throughout the project, mainly through desk research and background exploration to prepare the interview, but almost none of that was formally recorded or stored. The only piece of data that survived in a recoverable form was the final interview recording, which ended up being the only documented field research we had.

3. How were decisions made during the research process, and how were they documented?

Decisions were made continuously while preparing the interview and afterward when discussing what we heard, usually in meetings or quick check-ins. We did take notes at times, but they were spread across personal documents, chats, and laptops and were never consolidated into a shared project record.

4. At which moments did documentation play a role during the project?

Documentation mainly mattered at the end, when we had to deliver something concrete. During the research phase, we didn't experience documentation as something that needed to run alongside the work.

5. Was there a defined research method or analytical approach?

No, not explicitly. We knew we needed to do research to ask informed questions, but we didn't formalize a method or think about how that process should be documented.

6. How was the interview data processed and analyzed?

We listened back to the interview and worked through it together using notes and discussion to interpret what was relevant. Analysis definitely happened, but it wasn't frozen into a stable form, so the reasoning only lives indirectly in the final conclusions.

7. Were any steps taken to validate or verify the findings?

No, mainly because we were close to deadlines and already shifting toward finalizing the project. Validation didn't feel built into the workflow.

8. Were multiple data sources used to compare or check findings?

In practice, yes, because desk research informed the interview, but since that research wasn't preserved, the interview became the only visible source afterward.

9. How was the project data stored and managed?

The interview recording existed as a single file, but the supporting research, notes, and decisions were scattered across tools and personal spaces, without a shared structure tying them together.

10. Would another student team be able to continue or reuse your research?

They would see the interview, but they wouldn't understand the research that led up to it or how we interpreted it, so most of the logic behind the work would be missing.

11. Were expectations about documentation or reproducibility clear at the start?

Not really. We didn't have a clear sense that the research process itself needed to be preserved beyond the final deliverable.

12. How did assessment criteria influence how you worked?

The focus was clearly on producing a final result, so under time pressure we prioritized delivery over maintaining an audit trail.

13. What limitations do you now see in how the research was done?

Even though a lot of thinking and research happened, almost none of it is visible anymore, which makes the work hard to check or reuse.

14. What things most limited reproducibility in your project?

Time pressure, fragmented tooling, and the absence of a clear structure for documenting research decisions all played a role.

15. What would have helped make the research more reusable?

A simple requirement to store desk research, interview preparation, and decision making in one shared place would have preserved most of the work we actually did.

Cacao Track – Interview

1. Can you briefly describe your project and your role within it?

I led the Cacao track, which focused on ethical cacao sourcing and compliance with policies like EUDR, and I was responsible for shaping the research and coordinating the final guide.

2. What type of data did you collect during the project?

We didn't collect primary field data like interviews or surveys. The project was built entirely on desk research using reports, policy documents, academic papers, and NGO publications.

3. How were decisions made during the research process, and how were they documented?

We made decisions about which sources to trust and include during team discussions, but those choices were rarely written down. Once a source made it into the guide, the reasoning behind that choice was no longer visible.

4. At which moments did documentation play a role during the project?

Documentation mainly mattered when we were writing the guide itself. Earlier research decisions and comparisons between sources weren't documented as a process.

5. Was there a defined research method or analytical approach?

Not in a strict sense. We approached the project as a synthesis task, focused on combining existing knowledge rather than formally analyzing it.

6. How was the data processed and analyzed?

We summarized and translated source material into accessible language, but we didn't systematically compare sources or track disagreements between them.

7. Were any steps taken to validate or verify the findings?

No, we didn't formally validate the content with external experts or stakeholders, partly because the focus was on producing a usable guide within the project timeframe.

8. Were multiple data sources used to compare or check findings?

Multiple sources were used, but mostly to support statements rather than to actively test or challenge conclusions.

9. How was the project data stored and managed?

Sources were stored across links, PDFs, and drafts, without a central system showing how each source contributed to specific claims.

10. Would another student team be able to continue or reuse your research?

They could use the guide, but they wouldn't be able to reconstruct how we evaluated sources or why certain interpretations were chosen.

11. Were expectations about documentation or reproducibility clear at the start?

There was some awareness that structure mattered, but there was no concrete requirement to document research decisions.

12. How did assessment criteria influence how you worked?

The assessment rewarded a clear and polished output, so process documentation felt secondary.

13. What limitations do you now see in how the research was done?

There's no transparent link between individual sources and the conclusions in the guide.

14. What things most limited reproducibility in your project?

The lack of a structured way to record desk research decisions and comparisons.

15. What would have helped make the research more reusable?

A simple source tracking system that links evidence, decisions, and outputs.

Textile Track – Interview

1. Can you briefly describe your project and your role within it?

I led the Textile track, which focused on sustainability and ethics in textiles, mainly through visual work and presentations.

2. What type of data did you collect during the project?

We didn't collect formal research data like interviews or surveys. Most input came from online sources, inspiration material, and design exploration.

3. How were decisions made during the research process, and how were they documented?

Decisions were made while building visuals together, often in real time, but we didn't document why certain ideas or sources were chosen.

4. At which moments did documentation play a role during the project?

Documentation wasn't really part of the workflow, because the visuals themselves were treated as the output.

5. Was there a defined research method or analytical approach?

No, the project evolved through design and discussion rather than through a research method.

6. How was the data processed and analyzed?

Information was interpreted informally and turned into visuals without a separate analysis step.

7. Were any steps taken to validate or verify the findings?

No, validation wasn't part of the process.

8. Were multiple data sources used to compare or check findings?

Sources were used as inspiration, not as material to systematically compare or verify.

9. How was the project data stored and managed?

Everything lived in cloud tools like Canva and Miro, without exports or a stable archive.

10. Would another student team be able to continue or reuse your research?

Only if the platforms and links still work, because otherwise there's no preserved research trail.

11. Were expectations about documentation or reproducibility clear at the start?

Not clearly. Creativity was emphasized more than research traceability.

12. How did assessment criteria influence how you worked?

The focus was on presentation and creativity, not on documenting process.

13. What limitations do you now see in how the research was done?

There's no way to trace visuals back to specific sources or reasoning.

14. What things most limited reproducibility in your project?

Reliance on temporary tools and lack of documentation standards.

15. What would have helped make the research more reusable?

Clear rules for exporting work and documenting decisions alongside visuals.

Orga Track – Interview

1. Can you briefly describe your project and your role within it?

I worked on the Orga track, which focused on explaining how the VCH Lab operates rather than researching an external value chain.

2. What type of data did you collect during the project?

We didn't collect research data. The work was based on internal materials and presentations.

3. How were decisions made during the research process, and how were they documented?

Decisions followed existing lab practices, but they weren't documented as research decisions.

4. At which moments did documentation play a role during the project?

Documentation mainly supported presentations, not research traceability.

5. Was there a defined research method or analytical approach?

No, the work wasn't framed as research with a guiding question.

6. How was the data processed and analyzed?

There was no analysis step, since the goal was communication.

7. Were any steps taken to validate or verify the findings?

No, because there were no research findings in that sense.

8. Were multiple data sources used to compare or check findings?

No.

9. How was the project data stored and managed?

Materials were stored as slide decks without a research archive.

10. Would another student team be able to continue or reuse your work?

They could reuse the slides, but not treat them as research.

11. Were expectations about documentation or reproducibility clear at the start?

There was some awareness, but no enforcement.

12. How did assessment criteria influence how you worked?

Assessment focused on clarity and alignment with lab vision.

13. What limitations do you now see in how the work was done?

It doesn't support research continuity.

14. What things most limited reproducibility in your project?

The fact that the work was never positioned as research.

15. What would have helped make the work more reusable as research?

Clear criteria for when documentation is required.
